CYBER SECURITY 101

FIRST BLUE-TEAM HOME LAB

30 days. Free tools. One documented project for your portfolio.

30-DAY WORKBOOK | PDF

Before you start

A 30-day, beginner-friendly plan to build ONE documented blue-team home lab with free tools on the computer you already own, and turn it into a portfolio write-up.
No job or certification outcome is promised. Practise only on machines you own. Tool names belong to their owners; this guide is not affiliated with them.

What you need

A computer with at least 8 GB RAM (16 GB recommended) and ~60 GB free disk.
Free software: VirtualBox (virtualbox.org), Ubuntu Server (ubuntu.com), Wazuh (wazuh.com, open source SIEM/XDR).
Optional: Wireshark (wireshark.org).

Week 1 - Build

Day 1 install VirtualBox. Day 2 create Ubuntu Server VM; take snapshot. Day 3 create a second VM (endpoint). Day 4 host-only network; confirm ping. Day 5 SSH key-only login; disable password auth. Day 6 enable ufw; allow only SSH. Day 7 write up: diagram + what you did.